

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Adam plans to make a splash with *Winnie's World*.



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you been to a conference before? What kind?
- Why do people attend work conferences?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk or report about things, actions, events, or people related to work and job issues.
- I can discuss reasons and results of an event or action related to work and jobs.
- I can exchange complex professional information related to work and job issues.





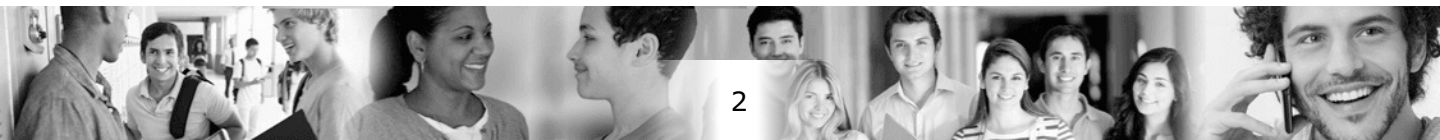
Let's Explore!

Adam and Kristi **devise*** a plan to get some extra brownie points.

* To "devise" means to form a plan.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Adam:** So how was your meeting this morning?
- Kristi:** Fine. I've had three meetings so far today, but I had a meeting with Denise because she wanted me to give a report about a new children's book.
- Adam:** How was the meeting? Have you ever given a report on a manuscript before?
- Kristi:** Yeah, I've presented a few book reviews before.
It was really good. She liked my opinions ... as a result, we are going to go forward with some ideas about the book.
- Adam:** What's this book about anyway?
- Kristi:** It's about a hedgehog who teaches children how to use social media safely while navigating through the turbulent waters of the Internet.
- Adam:** Turbulent waters?
- Kristi:** It's the writer in me. Seriously, it's a good book. I've read a lot of children books in the last while, but I think this was the best so far.
- Adam:** In what regard?
- Kristi:** Well, first, it's a great story and second, we could market it to schools. You know how much revenue that would generate if we were to get some school boards to incorporate it into their school curriculum? Problem is, I think the ending needs to be reworked, so we need to hold a meeting with the author.
- Adam:** Ok. I'm starting to see the big picture now. Maybe we can use this.
- Kristi:** What's that?
- Adam:** It's a flyer for a teacher's conference coming up next month in Chicago. I grabbed it in the public library. I wrote some girl's phone number on it, but the number wasn't legit. Anyway, it's a huge conference. Imagine if you could get your book up and running in time so that the company could market it there.
- Kristi:** That's it. That's the little extra leverage I need to sway the writer and probably Denise to make the necessary changes to the ending. You know what, you should pitch this idea to Denise as well! You could really gain some brownie points with the bosses if you could go to Chicago and make a splash with it by selling it.
- Adam:** I should try and convince Denise so I can go to Chicago for free. Have you ever been to a teacher conference? We could go together.
- Kristi:** No. Focus on the brass ring, Adam.





Let's Practice!

Adam tells Kristi what happened at the meeting.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write down the missing words. Choose either the Present Perfect tense or the Simple Past tense according to the verb given in parenthesis.

1. Have you ever _____ to a teacher conference? (to be)
2. So how _____ your meeting this morning? (to be)
3. I've _____ a few book reviews since January. (to present)
4. I _____ a meeting with Denise yesterday. (to have)
5. I've _____ a lot of children books in the last while. (to read)
6. I _____ it in the public library last month. (to grab)
7. Have you ever _____ a report on a manuscript before? (to give)
8. She _____ my opinions. (to like)



Let's Practice!

Can you give me a good reason?

Instructions: Circle the reason clauses. Underline the result clauses.

1. I should try and convince Denise so I can go to Chicago for free.
2. She liked my opinions; as a result, we are going to go forward with some ideas about the book.
3. I had a meeting with Denise because she wanted me to write a review about a children's book.
4. Imagine if you could get your book up and running in time so that the company could market it there.
5. As I read the children's book, I am able to write a review about it.





Extension Activity

My Life Experiences

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write 10 sentences about your unique, interesting or exciting life experiences or things you have done.
- Make 5 sentences true and 5 sentences false. Be creative!
- Read your sentences in groups.
- Ask questions to find out more information.
- Discuss which life experiences are true and which are false.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write sentences about my life experiences.

☐ ☐

I read my sentences aloud.

☐ ☐

I discuss my life experiences.

☐ ☐

I ask questions about my classmates' life experiences.

☐ ☐

I say which experiences I think are true or false.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- manuscript** (noun): an author's text that has not yet been published
e.g. Have you ever given a report on a manuscript before?
- turbulent** (adjective): characterized by conflict, disorder, or confusion
e.g. It's about a hedgehog who teaches children how to use social media safely while navigating through the turbulent waters of the Internet.
- in what regard** (expression): in connection with what aspect
e.g. Kristi: I think this was the best so far.
Adam: In what regard?
- to incorporate** (verb): to include something as part of something larger
e.g. You know how much revenue that would generate if we were to get some school boards to incorporate it into their school curriculum?
- to rework** (verb): to make changes to something in order to improve it
e.g. I think the ending needs to be reworked, so we need to hold a meeting with the author.
- to get up and running** (expression): to get ready; prepared; suitable for use
e.g. Imagine if you could get your book up and running in time for the company so that the company could market it there.
- brownie points** (expression): earning favor in the eyes of another, often one's superior
e.g. You could really gain some brownie points with the bosses if you could go to Chicago.
- to make a splash** (expression): to attract a great deal of attention
e.g. Make a splash with it by selling it.
- the brass ring** (expression): a prize or goal that someone strives for
e.g. Focus on the brass ring, Adam.
- to sway** (verb): to influence; to persuade
That's the little extra leverage I need to sway the writer.





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the **Present Perfect** tense to talk about an action that happened in the past and is important in the present or an action that began in the past and continues up to the present.

You use the **Simple Past** tense to talk about finished actions. These actions could be repeated in the past (but finished now), a short action in the past or an action that took place over a period of time in the past.

You can use the **Present Perfect** tense to talk about experience.

When you use the **Present Perfect** tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

*I **have learned** English.* = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

*He **has bought** a painting.* = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

It is common to use **for** and **since** when referring to time periods in the **Present Perfect**:

- You use **FOR** to talk about how long an action has been happening (a week, two days, five hours, six years etc).
- You use **SINCE** to talk about when the action started (2010, Monday, she was a child).

***Since** the moving van pulled away that day, his life **has not been** the same.*

Usually, when you use the **Simple Past** tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

***Yesterday**, I went to the store.*

*She moved away with her parents **several years ago**.*

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence, we would not use the Present Perfect. (~~Yesterday, I have been to the store~~).

Examples:

- *I've had three meetings so far today.*
- *Have you ever given a report on a manuscript before?*
- *I've presented a few book reviews before.*
- *So how was your meeting this morning?*





Learning Points

Reason and Result Clauses

In conversation and in writing, you often need to address the question *Why?* You can use a reason clause to explain why something happened.

When you want to talk about the result of an action or situation, you use a result clause.

Reason Clauses:

You can use the conjunctions *as* and *because* to introduce the reason clause.

***As** I don't know the intricacies of the process yet, I would like for you to train me a little longer.*

*I would like for you to train me a little longer **because** I don't know the intricacies of the process yet.*

Result Clauses:

You can use the conjunctions *so*, *so ... that* and *as a result* to introduce the result clause.

*The meeting was too long, **so** we missed another, more important meeting.*

*There were **so** many people talking at once **that** I couldn't hear myself think.*

*The meeting was long; **as a result**, we had lunch very late.*

Examples:

- *She liked my opinions; **as a result**, we are going to go forward with some ideas about the book.*
- *I had a meeting with Denise **because** she wanted me to give a report about a new children's book.*
- *I think the ending needs to be reworked, **so** we need to hold a meeting with the author.*
- *Imagine if you could get your book up and running in time for the company **so that** the company could market it there.*
- *I should try and convince Denise **so** I can go to Chicago for free.*

